Falcon Heist

General Overview

In the magical city of Astrea, there is a figure named Lord Delain. He is wealthy and powerful and holds many magical artifacts across several vaults in his sprawling estate. There is an upcoming masquerade he is hosting. Roughly 200 guests are invited, and he has an extensive private guard employed to boot.

A local thief, Marlowe, is down on his luck and in need of a score to pay back his loan shark, a local crime boss by of Vex Mortain is going to get his due from Marlowe one way or another. Marlowe meets the player at a local bar. The player is contracted to help Marlowe.

Strong Start

We begin our tale in the City of Astrea, a sprawling coastal city known for its aristocracy of mages, their factional houses, and the ensuing politics thereof. It's a city of excess, but also a city with its fair share of poverty.

Down on your financial luck recently, you've started to get involved in a bit of contract work. You have a good amount of combat skill from your past, and think that it could serve you well to take on a bit more dangerous work for a bit higher pay. You recently came across a contract that asked only for someone with prior combat or magic experience and the upmost discretion. It seems like a perfect fit for you.

The contract stated that you were to meet with this patron at The Brass Latern, a bit of dive tavern near the docks. On the way here all manner of sea salt air and screaming sailors have assaulted your senses. Inside, you sit down at a table in the middle of the room and laid the back of the contract face down on the table as it instructed. A simple yet elegant drawing of a fox is all that is there.

Now, you are going to make what is called a "Skill Check", using your Perception skill. (Advantage if Rogue)

On a success: You notice the hand of a human man going for your coin pouch and he stops short, retracting his hand before sitting down at the table, he says, "Good, nice to see you have your wits about you. That'll be important for the job. My name is Marlowe, who do I have the pleasure of meeting?"

On a failure: You see a pouch plop down in the center of the table. You immediately recognize it as your coin pouch. Followed by a thin young man with medium length brown hair sitting down across from you. "Looks like you're a bit green when it comes to stealing stuff. No worries, I can handle that. My name's Marlowe, and I believe I'm here to hire you for a job."

Marlowe will then describe his plan for the heist of Lord Delain's Gilded Falcon during the masquerade.

Scenes

- Opening scene with Marlowe, describes the heist
- The two make their preparations and get suited up; Marlowe can handle the forgery of the invitation if desired
- The two make their way to the Delain estate ahead of the masquerade
- The need to think of a distraction and then make their way into the falcon's vault
    - The vault is guarded by a imprisoned pixie and an animated armor
- The two then need to find a way to escape without being caught

Secrets and Clues

1. Some of the patrons of the masquerade sneak in drugs -- truly magical mushrooms that cause them to trip intensely. They go to hang out in one of the reading rooms inside the estate.
2. Marlowe is indebted to a crime lord Vex Mortain who wants the gilded falcon, and he will be in deep trouble if he fails to pay back his debt soon.
3. The vineyard has all sorts of magical enhancements to the vegetation to make it thrive better than it normally would
4. Lord and Lady Delain have immense wealth, but their true desire at this point is political power. They seek to aid the Mage House Dusk, of which they are high ranking members, to overtake Mage House Dawn.
5. Mage House Dusk is generally considered more on the darker side of magic, while Mage House Dawn is generally considered on the more altruistic side.
6. Mage House Dawn has their own share of internal power struggles, however. Their founder, an elf named Melvar, has been banished to a pocket dimension by Steward Cairos -- the leader of an upstart faction within house Dawn who seeks to work with house Dusk to lead Astrea on a military campaign to "spread their greatness" to the rest of the world.
7. Lord Delain has met with Cairos many times, and will meet with him at this Masquerade as well. He sees him as convenient for now, and will betray him when the time is right. Cairos has no love for house Dusk either, and will act similarly. They are only loyal to each other out of convenience, and they are both power hungry.
8. The Gilded Falcon lies in the Library's secret chamber. It is the oldest vault in the estate, and the least secure with the least valuables. Lord Delain simply has it linked to a book titled "On Advanced Falconry" which when moved triggers the mechanism opening a false door.
9. The Gilded Falcon vault is guarded by a sprite named Belair. Belair hates Lord Delain for trapping him in this chamber and bound to his service. It can only be broken if Lord Delain gives him a gift of some sort. Belair is willing to bargain rather than attack. The animated armor in the vault however is always hostile.
10. The taking of the Gilded Falcon sets off a magical alarm in one of the mage guards head. They will dispatch guards to the library as fast as possible, so it will be up to the distractions the group set up beforehand to slow them down.

Fantastic Locations

Lord Delain's Estate

- Sub Locations
    - The Arcane Vineyard by the Astrean Coast
    - Grape and Wine Cask storage
    - The Masquerade Courtyard of Lady Delain
    - The Gazebo of House Dusk
    - The Foyer of Delain Manor
    - The Reflecting Pools
    - The Grand Ballroom of House Delain
    - The Master Bedroom
    - The Library
        - Secret door to one of Lord Delain's many vaults, this one contains many scrolls and the **Gilded Falcon**
        - A pixie is trapped in this chamber, and there is a animated armor here as well.
    - The Reading Room
        - Next to the Library, no door in between
        - A group of affluent members of house dawn are about to do magic mushrooms
    - The Kitchen
    - The Cellar
    - The Vaults
        - Underneath the cellar there are 6 vault doors. These ones contain other various magic items, but not the **Gilded Falcon**. They are also much better guarded.
    - The Docks

NPCs

- Marlowe
- Lord Delain
- Lady Delain
- Renaas (Random party goer)
    - Friends: Tristan, Terri, and Philomena

Monsters

1. **Animated Armor:** AC 18; HP 33; Attacks 2x at +4 for 1d6 + 2 damage.
2. **Sprite:** AC 15; HP 10; Attacks 1x at +6 for 1d6 + 2 damage or 1 damage + Charm.
    1. Can turn invisible at will. Can be reasoned with. Hates Lord Delain, trapped here. Rings tiny bell as an alarm. Name is Belair
3. **Guards:** AC 16; HP 11; Attacks 1x at +3 for 1d6 + 1 damage
4. **Apprentice Mages:** AC 10; HP 11; Attacks 1x at +4 for 1d6 + 2 damage
    1. Can know any 1st level spells
5. **Veteran Mages:** AC 15; HP 30; Attacks 1x at +5 for 1d12 + 2 damage
    1. Can known any 1st or 2nd level spells

Treasure

In the library vault there is also:

- 256 GP and an emerald encrusted bracelet worth 200 GP
- Boots of Elvenkind
- Infernal antitoxin & 2 Healing Potions
- Various Spell Books: Unseen Servant, Hold Person, Arcane Lock, Knock, Shatter